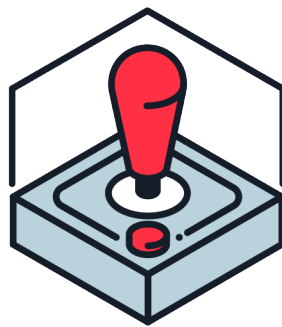




Video Game Metadata Schema: Controlled Vocabulary for **TRANSACTION TYPES**

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GAMER
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<https://github.com/uwgamergroup/vocabulary-transaction-type>

Version History

1.0: Initial release, published at DiGRA 2020¹
1.1: Revisions include: added "Gacha"; refined definitions of terms; formatting
1.1: December 2024, Formatting update: Updated page layout and typography settings to align with styles used in other VGMS materials. No changes to content.

Abbreviation Key

The following abbreviations are used throughout:

SN: Scope note
RT: Related term (See also)

¹ Windleharth, T., & Lee, J. H. (2020). Taxonomies for transactions and user engagement in mobile games. In *Proceedings of DiGRA 2020 Conference: Play Everywhere*.

Controlled Vocabulary for Transaction Types

The nature and mechanisms of value exchange between game players and developers.

1. Currency

Currency describes real and virtual monetary units that are used to purchase game content and in-game goods.

Real Currency

SN: Legal cash.

In-game Currency

SN: In-game digital currency.

RT: **Virtual Currency**.

Premium Currency

SN: A rare and exclusive form of in-game currency.

RT: **Exclusive Currency, Rare Currency**.

2. Transaction Types

Transaction types come in two forms: direct monetization and indirect monetization.

Direct Monetization

SN: Company receives direct cash payments.

NT: **Subscription; Ad Removal; Real Currency Gambling**

Subscription

SN: Pay a periodic fee for bonus or exclusive content.

BT: **Direct Monetization**

Ad Removal

SN: Pay real money to avoid ads.

BT: **Direct Monetization**

Real Currency Gambling

SN: Gamble with real money.

BT: **Direct Monetization**

Indirect Monetization

SN: A board that shows names and scores, ranking the leaders in a competition.

NT: **Viewing Ads (Required); Viewing Ads (Optional); Virtual Currency Gambling; Acquisition**

Viewing Ads (Required)

SN: Ads appear on screen, and sometimes between levels.

BT: **Indirect Monetization**

Viewing Ads (Optional)

SN: Ads players can elect to watch for in-game goods

BT: **Indirect Monetization**

Virtual Currency Gambling

SN: Players gamble with virtual currency.

BT: **Indirect Monetization**

Acquisition

SN: Players use social media and other systems to recruit new players or re-engage former players.

BT: **Indirect Monetization**

3. Resources

This category describes the various resources players acquire with transactions.

Direct Gameplay Advantage

SN: Resources that convey benefits in the game system mechanics.

NT: **Powerups, Permanent Boost**

Powerups

SN: Resource that provides time-limited benefits.

BT: **Direct Gameplay Advantage**

RT: **Bufs**

Permanent Boost

SN: Resource that conveys a permanent advantage to the player's game state.

BT: **Direct Gameplay Advantage**

Limited Content

SN: Exclusive, premium game features not available to all players.

RT: **Exclusive Content.**

Remove Time Related Barriers

SN: Reducing or removing limitations to time played, or turn timers.

RT: **Appointment Mechanics, Energy Mechanics, Turn Timers.**

Customization

SN: Cosmetic objects for character avatars or environments.

RT: **Skins.**

Inventory Capacity

SN: Ability to store more in-game resources.

RT: **Bag Space.**

Gacha

SN: Random items or characters obtained through a lottery-like process, unrelated to player achievement.

RT: **Loot Boxes, Random Goods.**

Random Goods

SN: A resource generating random in-game goods.

RT: **Loot Boxes.**

More Items

SN: Acquiring more materials, weapons, or other items used in-game.

4. Marketing Methods

Strategies to promote or sell games or in-game content such as advertisements, limited offers, etc.

Game as Ad

SN: The game is also an ad for merchandise.

Merchandise Store

SN: Merchandise store integrated into game application.

Limited-Time Offer

SN: Time-limited sale, or time-limited availability of rare game goods.

Special Events

SN: Time-limited events featuring temporary thematic game content.

RT: **Special Occasions.**